



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "does free will explain all evil?" is written in white, lowercase, sans-serif font, arranged in three lines.

does free
will explain
all evil?

One kind of example is what is sometimes called 'natural evil.' These are evils which do not seem to be caused by free will. Examples include the consequences of natural disasters like hurricanes and tsunamis, and the often terrible effects of disease.

However, the tsunami does not seem to have been the
result of anyone's free choices.

The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami is an evil.

Suppose that you think that all of these assumptions are true. That does not mean that we have a satisfactory treatment of the existence of evil from a theist perspective.

there are possible
situations which an
omnipotent
being cannot
bring about



we have
free will



free will is
a great good



the ability
to harm others
is a great good

That is because even if we might have an explanation of why there is **some** evil in the world, we do not yet have an explanation of why we find in the world the particular kinds of evils we do.

Let's take a particular example: the 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami, which is estimated to have killed about 228,000 people. The following seems very plausible:

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The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami is available

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there could be evil in a world with a omnipotent and perfectly good

God. It can explain that, it seems, if we make the following assumption:

Summing up so far: we have seen that freewill promises to explain how

there are possible
situations which an
omnipotent
being cannot
bring about



we have
free will



free will is
a great good



the ability
to harm others
is a great good

**Free will
cannot
explain any
evil.**

Free will can explain some evil; but it can't explain all of the evil we find in the world.

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The 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami is an evil.



















































































































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